All in all, I was in a bad state after the 2007 World Cup. I was not enjoying my cricket at all and was thinking about retiring – until I received some encouraging words from Viv Richards. Out of the blue, he called me in India from the West Indies and we spoke for about forty-five minutes. He assured me that there was a lot of cricket left in me and insisted that I shouldn't even think about stopping playing.

Viv was my hero when I was growing up and he will always be a hero, no matter what success I've achieved myself. We have got to know each other well over the years and whenever we meet, he treats me like his younger brother and I treat him like my older brother. I've always respected him and his views, so when he chose to call me and spend all that time convincing me to carry on, it meant a great deal to me. When I finally got back into some good form and put together a very satisfying century in Sydney at the beginning of 2008, I made a point of calling Viv to thank him for his crucial support.

India in the 2007 World Cup

8th match, Group B. Bangladesh v India at Port-of-Spain. 17 March 2007
India 191 (49.3/50 ov); Bangladesh 192–5 (48.3/50 ov)
Bangladesh won by 5 wickets (with 9 balls remaining)

12th match, Group B. Bermuda v India at Port-of-Spain. 19 March 2007
India 413–5 (50/50 ov); Bermuda 156 (43.1/50 ov)
India won by 257 runs

20th match, Group B. India v Sri Lanka at Port-of-Spain. 23 March 2007
Sri Lanka 254–6 (50/50 ov); India 185 (43.3/50 ov)
Sri Lanka won by 69 runs

Final. Australia v Sri Lanka at Bridgetown. 28 April 2007
Australia 281–4 (38/38 ov); Sri Lanka 215–8 (36/36 ov, target: 269)
Australia won by 53 runs (D/L method)